Lesson 06 material: Coping: Discussion, Listening and Reading

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 1: Academic Writing Essentials · Psychology

2.1: Discussion

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Answer the following questions based on your experience and opinion. Read five classmates' posts and respond to two classmates pointing out any similarities or differences, asking clarifying questions, or giving your opinion on a point they make.

1. What do you do when you are stressed? Do you have strategies to diminish your stress?
2. What situations make you stressed?

2.2: Listening-5 Unhealthy Coping Mechanisms You Shouldn't Ignore

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

1.2.2.1. Exercise 1-Listening Comprehension

Watch the video 5 Unhealthy Coping Mechanisms You Shouldn't Ignore and build a basic understanding to prepare you for this chapter's reading. Answer the questions to check your comprehension.

1. Which of the following mechanisms is an unhealthy way to deal with stress?
    a. exercise
    b. listening to music
    c. staying positive about all situations
2. Which of the following is not an example of toxic positivity?
    a. "Don't think about it, be positive!"
    b. "Everything will work out in the end."
    c. "If I can do it, so can you."
    d. "It could be worse."
    e. "It's OK to feel bad sometimes."
3. What is a healthy way to deal with social anxiety?
    a. Force yourself to attend parties.
    b. Isolate in your room.
    c. Invite someone you feel comfortable with to accompany you in social situations.
    d. Use social media to make friends.
4. The fourth unhealthy coping mechanism relates to repressing emotions. However, it is possible to overreact. Which strategy to minimize emotion was not provided?
    a. yelling into a pillow
    b. meditating
    c. dancing
    d. talking on the phone

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(Picture: Image 6 Photo by RUN 4 FFWPU from Pexels)

Image 6 *Photo by **RUN 4 FFWPU** from **Pexels***

Links on the original page

- 5 Unhealthy Coping Mechanisms You Shouldn't Ignore: https://youtu.be/PyIyxeMXKeg

2.3: Reading-Coping Mechanisms

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

1.2.3.1. Exercise 2-Reading Comprehension

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

1People have many different strategies for dealing with stressful situations — some helpful, and some not so helpful. Psychologists call these "coping mechanisms." A coping mechanism is a method that a person uses to deal with stress or conflict. It is a way for a person to "master" or minimize the effect of a stressful situation.

2Psychologists categorize coping mechanisms into two different categories: adaptive coping mechanisms and maladaptive coping mechanisms.

1.2.3.1.1. Adaptive Coping Mechanisms

3Adaptive coping mechanisms are positive ways people alleviate stress.

1.2.3.1.1.1. Anticipation

4Anticipation is a way to reduce the stress of a difficult challenge by anticipating what it will be like and preparing for how to cope with it. Some literary critics believe that this is the reason why people enjoy reading about, watching, and analyzing tragedies. Thinking about tragic events helps people prepare for unforeseen difficult circumstances.

1.2.3.1.1.2. Seeking Support

5Finding emotional support from others or asking for help can be an instrumental way of maintaining emotional health during a difficult period. The brain's response to worry enhances the effectiveness of this strategy. Stress releases neurohormones that strengthen your ability to seek emotional support by increasing your empathy and encouraging you to look for close social bonds.

1.2.3.1.1.3. Problem-Solving

6Problem-solving focuses on locating the source of the problem and determining solutions, or action steps. Developing a plan can help lessen stress that comes from the unknown. Problem-solving can be strengthened by creativity, and it is a useful response to both simple and complex issues. A strong problem-solving process involves defining the issue, brainstorming alternatives, evaluating and choosing between these alternatives, and implementing solutions.

1.2.3.1.1.4. Humor

7People of all ages and cultures respond to humor. Studies show people who laugh and smile often live longer and develop healthier relationships. Humor is also a common coping mechanism because it can diffuse the tension of a stressful situation. However, when humor is overused as a coping mechanism, it can lead to denial or avoidance (explained later).

(Picture: Image 7 Photo by Monstera from Pexels)

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1.2.3.1.2. Maladaptive Coping Mechanisms

8Maladaptive, or negative, coping mechanisms are more effective in the short term than the long term. Using a maladaptive coping mechanism may help people diminish negative feelings for a few days or weeks. But usually, these strategies may only make stress levels rise in the long run.

1.2.3.1.2.1. Denial

9Denial is the refusal to accept truth or fact. People are said to be "in denial" when they act as if the problem doesn't exist, refusing to acknowledge the reality of a situation. Sigmund Freud, the famous psychoanalyst who was the first person to study the significance of dreams, is credited with popularizing the idea of denial. He explains it as the moment when a person is faced with a

fact too uncomfortable to accept. Instead of facing the problem, the person decides to reject its existence or minimize its importance despite overwhelming evidence proving the contrary. Freud believed that denial was a primitive coping mechanism — one that babies develop in early childhood.

1.2.3.1.2.2. Projection

10Another maladaptive coping mechanism is projection. People are said to "project" their emotions on others when they blame someone else for having an emotion that they feel is unacceptable. For example, a husband who feels angry at his wife may accuse her of being the angry one instead of admitting that he is actually the angry one.

1.2.3.1.2.3. Dissociation

11Dissociation is another maladaptive coping mechanism. It is when a person tries to "disconnect" from a traumatic or stressful event. In extreme cases, a person who has dissociative behavior may even invent a new imaginary world where they do not have to face an uncomfortable feeling or memory.

12While dealing with stress, it is important to prioritize your physical, mental, and social well being. When you are facing a stressful situation, learn to relax so that you can carefully evaluate how you should respond. It is also important to maintain your mental health: think positively, exercise frequently, get enough sleep, and don't be afraid to express emotions and ask for help. If you follow these simple strategies, you'll have an easier time responding to the inevitable stress that you will face in your life.

1. PART A: Which of the following statements best expresses a central idea of the text?
    a. The best way to cope with stress is to remain positive and ignore all negative emotions, rather than dwell on stressful situations.
    b. Studying one's dreams is a great adaptive coping mechanism because it prompts one to reflect on their life choices.
    c. All adaptive coping mechanisms become maladaptive if utilized and relied on too frequently.
    d. People use different methods to deal with stress, which can produce positive and negative consequences depending on how one chooses to cope.
2. PART B: Which quote from the text best supports the answer to Part A?
    a. "People have many different strategies for dealing with stressful situations — some helpful, and some not so helpful." (Paragraph 1)
    b. "when humor is overused as a coping mechanism, it can lead to denial or avoidance" (Paragraph 7)
    c. "Sigmund Freud, the famous psychoanalyst who was the first person to study the significance of dreams, is credited with popularizing the idea of denial." (Paragraph 9)
    d. "a person who has dissociative behavior may even invent a new imaginary world where they do not have to face an uncomfortable feeling or memory." (Paragraph 11)
3. PART A: What does "primitive" mean as it is used in paragraph 9?
    a. uncivilized
    b. old-fashioned
    c. instinctive
    d. foolish
4. PART B: Which phrase from paragraph 9 best supports the answer to Part A?
    a. "to reject its existence"
    b. "despite overwhelming evidence"
    c. "proving the contrary"
    d. "develop in early childhood"
5. What is the author's primary purpose in this text?
    a. to inform the reader about various adaptive and maladaptive coping mechanisms
    b. to advise the reader on how to deal with specific stressful situations
    c. to explain how stress can harm someone mentally, emotionally, and physically
    d. to provide a history of psychology and its everyday benefits

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- Coping Mechanisms: https://www.commonlit.org/en/texts/coping-mechanisms
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16.2: Chapter 2

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4.2.1. Listening Comprehension

00:00 (bright guitar music) (writing utensil scratching)

00:04 (bell dings)

00:06 - [Teacher] Hey there Psych2Goers,

00:07 and welcome back to another video.

00:09 According to statistics, only a small percentage of you

00:11 who watch our videos, are actually subscribed.

00:13 If you haven't subscribed to us, do consider doing so,

00:16 if you enjoy what you see.

00:18 It would help a lot with YouTube's algorithm

00:19 in promoting more of our mental health content.

00:22 Now, let's continue.

00:24 We all have different ways

00:25 of dealing with stressful circumstances.

00:27 Maybe you like to go to the gym and workout,

00:29 or maybe you like to turn the music up in your car

00:32 and sing along to the radio, when you're stressed out.

00:35 Either way, these two types of coping mechanisms are good

00:38 and healthy, since they aren't harmful to you or others.

00:42 But there are some unhealthy coping mechanisms

00:44 that you might have due to stress,

00:47 that can be harmful to you and or other people.

00:50 With that said, here are five common

00:52 unhealthy coping mechanisms that you shouldn't ignore.

00:55 Number one, forced positivity.

00:59 I'm sure you've heard the term, good vibes only.

01:01 This statement and its accompanying sentiments,

01:04 have become part of our societal culture.

01:06 Of course, there's nothing wrong

01:07 with having a positive mindset.

01:09 Positivity can be a pretty powerful tool

01:11 when you wanna manifest that in your life.

01:13 However, the notion of only positive vibes,

01:16 have been taken to the extreme.

01:18 Toxic positivity.

01:20 Toxic positivity does not come

01:22 from a place of genuine happiness,

01:24 it comes from a place of denial,

01:25 invalidation or minimization.

01:28 It's an attempt to display a positive disposition

01:31 at all times, even when you're not in the best of moods.

01:34It's usually so excessive,

01:35 that the toxic positivity phrases are obvious.

01:38 Some examples of toxic positivity are,

01:41 “Don't think about it, be positive.

01:43 Everything will work out in the end.

01:44 If I can do it, so can you."

01:46 Or, "It could be worse."

01:48 When you force yourself to be positive at all times,

01:51 you're barring and repressing your emotions,

01:54 which can lead to doubt, shame,

01:56 and relational problems with others.

01:58 Sometimes life just sucks,

02:01 and no amount of positivity can fix it.

02:04 It's all right to be angry, jealous,

02:06 annoyed or deeply upset about things.

02:09 The good and the bad emotions are all part of being human.

02:13 Number two, isolating yourself.

02:16 For now, being socially distant is our safest option.

02:20 But there're other ways you might be isolating yourself

02:22 without realizing it.

02:24 Socially isolating yourself

02:25 simply because you don't like the people who are around you,

02:27 is not a healthy habit.

02:29 This can make it harder for you to relate to others overall,

02:32 when you do something like this.

02:34 As a species, we are social creatures

02:36 and we crave and need proper connection with other people.

02:40 You can learn a lot from the people around you.

02:42 When you connect with others in a healthy manner

02:44 through supportive conversations and good healthy talks,

02:48 you're allowing yourself to grow emotionally and mentally.

02:51 Fostering your mental resilience can be helpful

02:54 when times of stress do arise.

02:56 If you feel anxious in social situations,

02:59 try going to an event with someone you know,

03:01 or reach out to a professional therapist,

03:03 who can teach you techniques to reduce the stress you feel
03:06 caused by social situations.
03:08 Number three, fatalism.
03:11 When somebody bad happens,
03:12 our brains immediately embellish the event,
03:15 that makes it seem like it's the worst possible thing
03:17 to have ever happened to you.
03:19 It's a mental trait that has kept humans alive
03:21 for millions of years,
03:22 so the same mistakes won't be repeated in need of survival.
03:26 However, in our modern day society,
03:29 it functions as a self-defense mechanism,
03:32 you prepare for the worst just in case.
03:34 But, this behavior might be causing you more stress
03:37 than necessary.
03:38 High levels of stress can lead to severe
03:40 mental and physical health problems,
03:41 like depression and even heart disease.
03:44 A tool to help overcome this need to catastrophize would be,
03:47 to allow yourself to think of the five top worst outcomes.
03:51 And then, ask yourself,
03:52 how likely they are to actually happen.
03:55 If you feel like a bad outcome is truly likely,
03:58 then plan for that one outcome,
04:00 create a plan that is flexible
04:02 and doable in case it needs to change.
04:05 This will give you a better sense of security going forward,
04:08 and create less stress in your life.
04:10 Number four, repressing your feelings.
04:13 Are you you repressing your feelings
04:15 because you think that no one cares?
04:17 Or that it's a waste of time?
04:19 Often, this behavior is a type of self-defense mechanism,
04:23 that activates when you believe that you no longer
04:25 have control over a certain situation.
04:28 Whether you choose to overreact or under react,
04:31 you are not giving your emotions a chance to be aired out.
04:35 While there should be a degree
04:37 of emotional self-control in place,
04:39 we should remember to be genuine with how we're feeling
04:42 and express it calmly and reasonably,

04:45 in a way that does not harm others.

04:47 If you are more likely to overreact

04:49 when something goes wrong, notice any physiological changes.

04:53 Usually your body is a good indicator

04:56 of how you're actually feeling.

04:58 Taking a moment to meditate and ground yourself

05:00 in your body, can help you minimize stress

05:02 and reduce emotional outbursts.

05:04 There're other ways to shake out repressed emotions,

05:06 such as yelling into a pillow, dancing or working out.

05:10 Number five, romanticizing the past.

05:13 The past can hold a certain appeal,

05:16 when we put our nostalgic goggles on,

05:18 especially when the present looks dim and not as promising.

05:22 Unfortunately, we can't resurrect the past.

05:26 Things happened and chances are, they did not happen

05:29 exactly as you imagined they would.

05:31 Living in a nostalgic daydream of what could have been,

05:34 can rob you of opportunities that you need

05:36 to be taking advantage of in your current present.

05:40 If you find yourself taking frequent trips down memory lane,

05:43 figure out what specifically appeals to you

05:45 about those memories, and try to recreate them

05:48 in the present.

05:49 The present can sometimes be dim and gray,

05:52 but your perspective depends on how you choose to handle it.

05:57 So, which of these coping mechanisms did you relate to most?

06:00 How do you healthily or unhealthily

06:03 cope with stressful circumstances?

06:05 Share your experiences with us in the comments below.

06:07 Please, like and share this video if it helped you,

06:09 and you think it could help someone else too.

06:11 The studies and references used are listed

06:13 in the description below.

06:14 Don't forget to hit the subscribe button

06:16 from more Psych2Go videos and thank you for watching.

06:18 We'll see you next time.

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